

Class 18: Pertussis and the CMI-PB mini project

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Background

Pertussis (a.k.a Whooping cough) is a highly contagious lung infects caused by the bacteria *Bordetella pertussis*.

The CDC tracks case numbers in the US and makes this available online:

Warning: package 'ggplot2' was built under R version 4.5.2

Warning: package 'readr' was built under R version 4.5.2

```
-- Attaching core tidyverse packages ----- tidyverse 2.0.0 --
v dplyr      1.1.4      v readr      2.1.6
v forcats    1.0.1      v stringr    1.6.0
v lubridate  1.9.4      v tibble     3.3.0
```

```

v purrr      1.2.0      v tidyr      1.3.1
-- Conflicts ----- tidyverse_conflicts() --
x dplyr::filter() masks stats::filter()
x dplyr::lag()     masks stats::lag()
i Use the conflicted package (<http://conflicted.r-lib.org/>) to force all conflicts to become

```

Attaching package: 'jsonlite'

The following object is masked from 'package:purrr':

flatten

```

# assign the CDC pertussis case number data to a data frame called cdc

# tools > addins > browse addins > paste df
cdc <- data.frame(
  Year = c(1922L,1923L,1924L,1925L,
           1926L,1927L,1928L,1929L,1930L,1931L,
           1932L,1933L,1934L,1935L,1936L,
           1937L,1938L,1939L,1940L,1941L,1942L,
           1943L,1944L,1945L,1946L,1947L,
           1948L,1949L,1950L,1951L,1952L,
           1953L,1954L,1955L,1956L,1957L,1958L,
           1959L,1960L,1961L,1962L,1963L,
           1964L,1965L,1966L,1967L,1968L,1969L,
           1970L,1971L,1972L,1973L,1974L,
           1975L,1976L,1977L,1978L,1979L,1980L,
           1981L,1982L,1983L,1984L,1985L,
           1986L,1987L,1988L,1989L,1990L,
           1991L,1992L,1993L,1994L,1995L,1996L,
           1997L,1998L,1999L,2000L,2001L,
           2002L,2003L,2004L,2005L,2006L,2007L,
           2008L,2009L,2010L,2011L,2012L,
           2013L,2014L,2015L,2016L,2017L,2018L,
           2019L,2020L,2021L,2022L,2023L),
  Cases = c(107473,164191,165418,152003,
            202210,181411,161799,197371,
            166914,172559,215343,179135,265269,
            180518,147237,214652,227319,103188,
            183866,222202,191383,191890,109873,
            133792,109860,156517,74715,69479,

```

```

120718,68687,45030,37129,60886,
62786,31732,28295,32148,40005,
14809,11468,17749,17135,13005,6799,
7717,9718,4810,3285,4249,3036,
3287,1759,2402,1738,1010,2177,2063,
1623,1730,1248,1895,2463,2276,
3589,4195,2823,3450,4157,4570,
2719,4083,6586,4617,5137,7796,6564,
7405,7298,7867,7580,9771,11647,
25827,25616,15632,10454,13278,
16858,27550,18719,48277,28639,32971,
20762,17972,18975,15609,18617,
6124,2116,3044,7063)
)

```

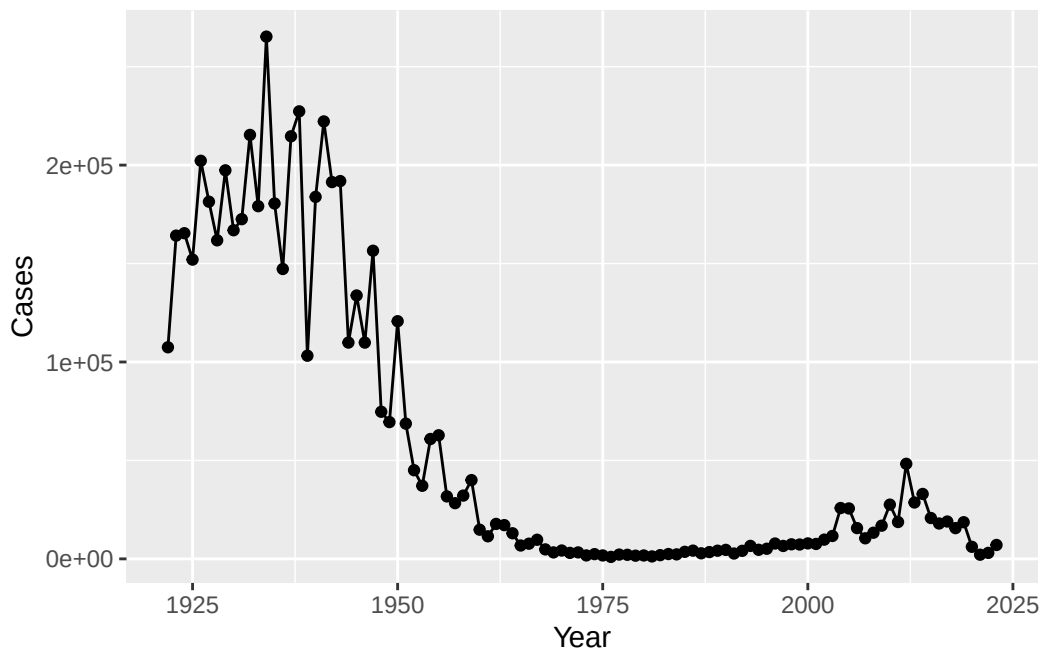
Investigating pertussis cases by year

Q1. With the help of the R “addin” package datapasta assign the CDC pertussis case number data to a data frame called cdc and use ggplot to make a plot of cases numbers over time.

```

ggplot(cdc) +
  aes(x=Year, y = Cases) +
  geom_point() +
  geom_line()

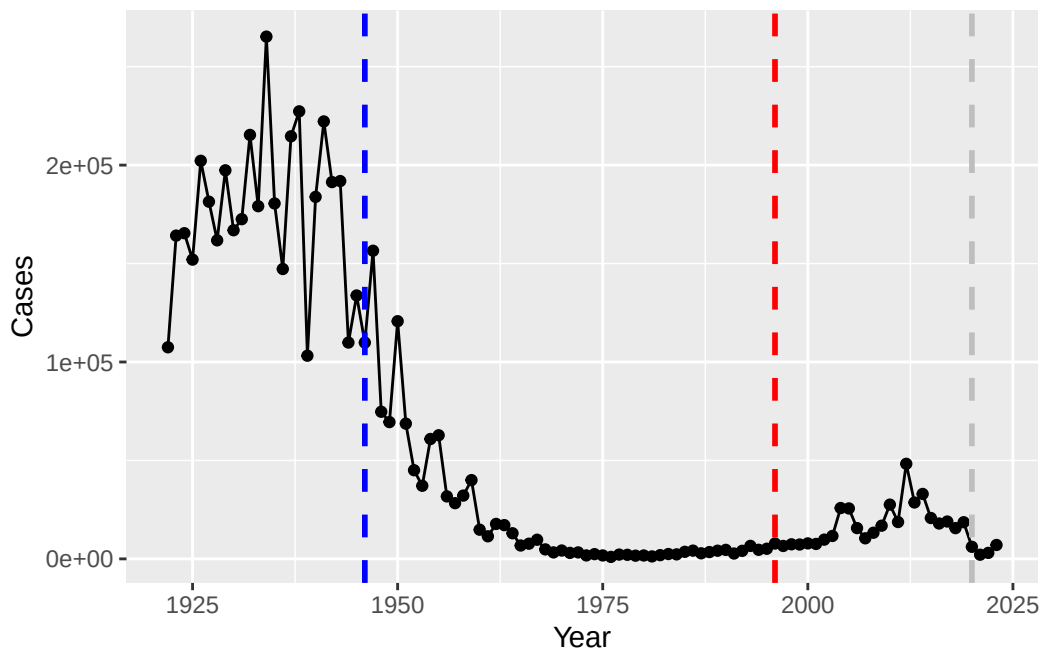
```



A tale of two vaccines (wP and aP)

Q2. Using the ggplot `geom_vline()` function add lines to your previous plot for the 1946 introduction of the wP (whole cell) vaccine and the 1996 switch to aP vaccine. The original wP deployment in 1947 and the newer aP (acellular) vaccine rolls out in 1996. What do you notice?

```
ggplot(cdc) +
  aes(x=Year, y = Cases) +
  geom_point() +
  geom_line() +
  geom_vline(xintercept = 1946, linetype="dashed",
             color = "blue", linewidth=1) +
  geom_vline(xintercept = 1996, linetype="dashed",
             color = "red", linewidth=1) +
  geom_vline(xintercept = 2020, linetype="dashed",
             color = "grey", linewidth=1)
```



Q3. Describe what happened after the introduction of the aP vaccine? Do you have a possible explanation for the observed trend?

The whole cell vaccine introduction in 1946 led to a dramatic decrease in pertussis cases over the following decades, with more variation in the beginning years, probably to get people to adopt it. However, after the switch to the acellular vaccine in 1996, there appears to be an increase in pertussis cases, suggesting that the aP vaccine may not be as effective in controlling the disease as the wP vaccine was, or not as effective long-term. Or with the need to get boosters, people forgot to get them which coupled with the short-term protection made cases rise.

Exploring CMI-PB data

The CMI-Pertusis boost (PB) project focuses on gathering data on this very topic. What is distinct between aP and wP individuals over time when they encounter Pertussis again.

They make their data available via a JSON format returning API. We can read JSON format with the `read_json()` function from the **jsonlite** package.

```
subject <- read_json("http://cmi-pb.org/api/v5_1/subject", simplifyVector = TRUE)
```

How many subjects are in the dataset?

```
nrow(subject)
```

```
[1] 172
```

Q4. How many aP and wP infancy vaccinated subjects are in the dataset?

```
table(subject$infancy_vac)
```

```
aP wP  
87 85
```

Q5. How many Male and Female subjects/patients are in the dataset?

```
table(subject$biological_sex)
```

```
Female  Male  
112     60
```

Q6. What is the breakdown of race and biological sex (e.g. number of Asian females, White males etc...)? This is not representative of the US population

```
table(subject$race, subject$biological_sex)
```

	Female	Male
American Indian/Alaska Native	0	1
Asian	32	12
Black or African American	2	3
More Than One Race	15	4
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	1	1
Unknown or Not Reported	14	7
White	48	32

Let's read more tables from the CMI-PB dataset.

```
# specimen information  
specimen <- read_json("http://cmi-pb.org/api/v5_1/specimen", simplifyVector = TRUE)  
  
# antibody titer levels  
ab_titer <- read_json("http://cmi-pb.org/api/v5_1/plasma_ab_titer", simplifyVector = TRUE)
```

Side-note: working with dates

Q7. Using this approach determine (i) the average age of wP individuals, (ii) the average age of aP individuals; and (iii) are they significantly different?

Q8. Determine the age of all individuals at time of boost?

Q9. With the help of a faceted boxplot or histogram (see below), do you think these two groups are significantly different?

Joining multiple tables

Join (or link, or merge) using the `inner_join()` function from **dplyr**.

Q9. Complete the code to join specimen and subject tables to make a new merged data frame containing all specimen records along with their associated subject details

```
library(dplyr)

meta <- inner_join(subject, specimen)
```

Joining with ``by = join_by(subject_id)``

Q10. Now using the same procedure join meta with titer data so we can further analyze this data in terms of time of visit aP/wP, male/female etc.

```
ab_data <- inner_join(meta, ab_titer)
```

Joining with ``by = join_by(specimen_id)``

```
head(ab_data)
```

	subject_id	infancy_vac	biological_sex	ethnicity	race
1	1	wP	Female	Not Hispanic or Latino	White
2	1	wP	Female	Not Hispanic or Latino	White
3	1	wP	Female	Not Hispanic or Latino	White
4	1	wP	Female	Not Hispanic or Latino	White
5	1	wP	Female	Not Hispanic or Latino	White
6	1	wP	Female	Not Hispanic or Latino	White

year_of_birth	date_of_boost	dataset	specimen_id
---------------	---------------	---------	-------------

1	1986-01-01	2016-09-12	2020_dataset	1
2	1986-01-01	2016-09-12	2020_dataset	1
3	1986-01-01	2016-09-12	2020_dataset	1
4	1986-01-01	2016-09-12	2020_dataset	1
5	1986-01-01	2016-09-12	2020_dataset	1
6	1986-01-01	2016-09-12	2020_dataset	1

	actual_day_relative_to_boost	planned_day_relative_to_boost	specimen_type
1	-3	0	Blood
2	-3	0	Blood
3	-3	0	Blood
4	-3	0	Blood
5	-3	0	Blood
6	-3	0	Blood

	visit	isotype	is_antigen_specific	antigen	MFI	MFI_normalised	unit
1	1	IgE	FALSE	Total	1110.21154	2.493425	UG/ML
2	1	IgE	FALSE	Total	2708.91616	2.493425	IU/ML
3	1	IgG	TRUE	PT	68.56614	3.736992	IU/ML
4	1	IgG	TRUE	PRN	332.12718	2.602350	IU/ML
5	1	IgG	TRUE	FHA	1887.12263	34.050956	IU/ML
6	1	IgE	TRUE	ACT	0.10000	1.000000	IU/ML

	lower_limit_of_detection
1	2.096133
2	29.170000
3	0.530000
4	6.205949
5	4.679535
6	2.816431

Q11. How many specimens (i.e. entries in ab_data) do we have for each isotype?

```
unique(ab_data$isotype)
```

```
[1] "IgE" "IgG" "IgG1" "IgG2" "IgG3" "IgG4"
```

How many different Antigens are there in the dataset?

```
unique(ab_data$antigen)
```

```
[1] "Total" "PT" "PRN" "FHA" "ACT" "LOS" "FELD1"
[8] "BETV1" "LOLP1" "Measles" "PTM" "FIM2/3" "TT" "DT"
[15] "OVA" "PD1"
```



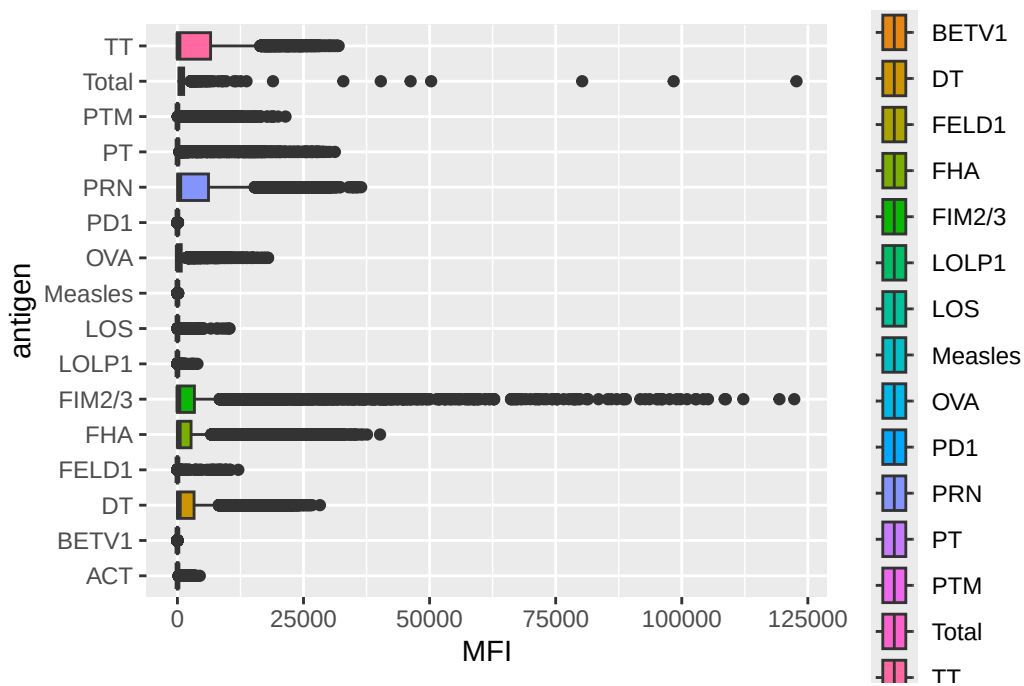
```
table(ab_data$antigen)
```

ACT	BETV1	DT	FELD1	FHA	FIM2/3	LOLP1	LOS	Measles	OVA
1970	1970	6318	1970	6712	6318	1970	1970	1970	6318
PD1	PRN	PT	PTM	Total	TT				
1970	6712	6712	1970	788	6318				

Let's plot antigen MFI levels across the whole dataset

```
ggplot(ab_data) +
  aes(x=MFI, y =antigen, fill=antigen) +
  geom_boxplot()
```

Warning: Removed 1 row containing non-finite outside the scale range (`stat\_boxplot()`).



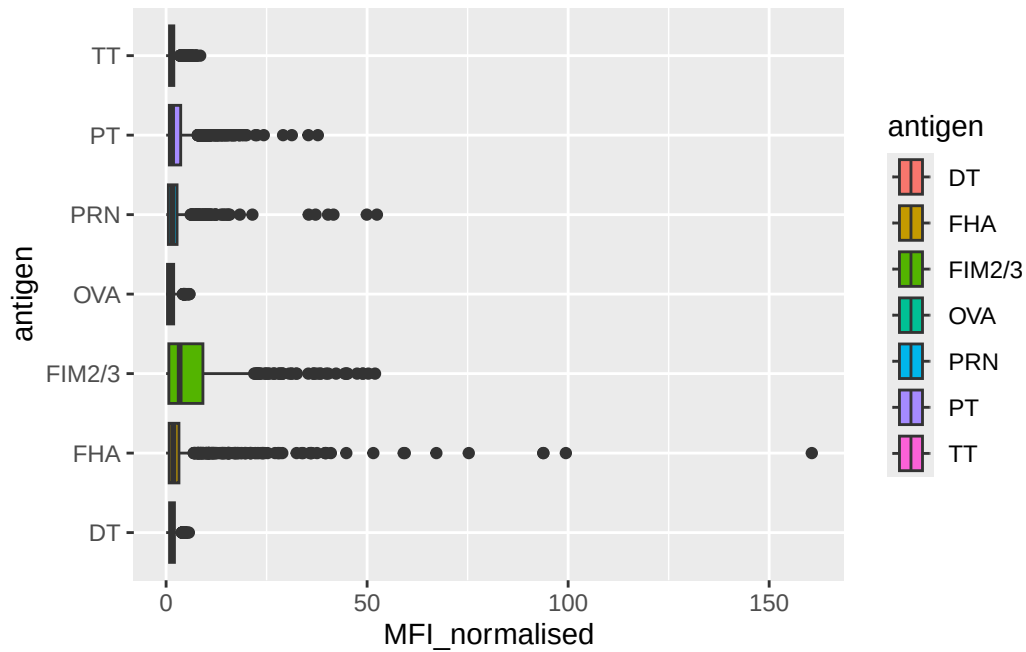
IgG is crucial for long-term immunity and responding to bacterial and viral infections. Plot an antigen MFI levels for just IgG isotype

```

igg <- ab_data |>
  filter(isotype == "IgG")

ggplot(igg) +
  aes(x=MFI_normalised, y =antigen, fill=antigen) +
  geom_boxplot()

```



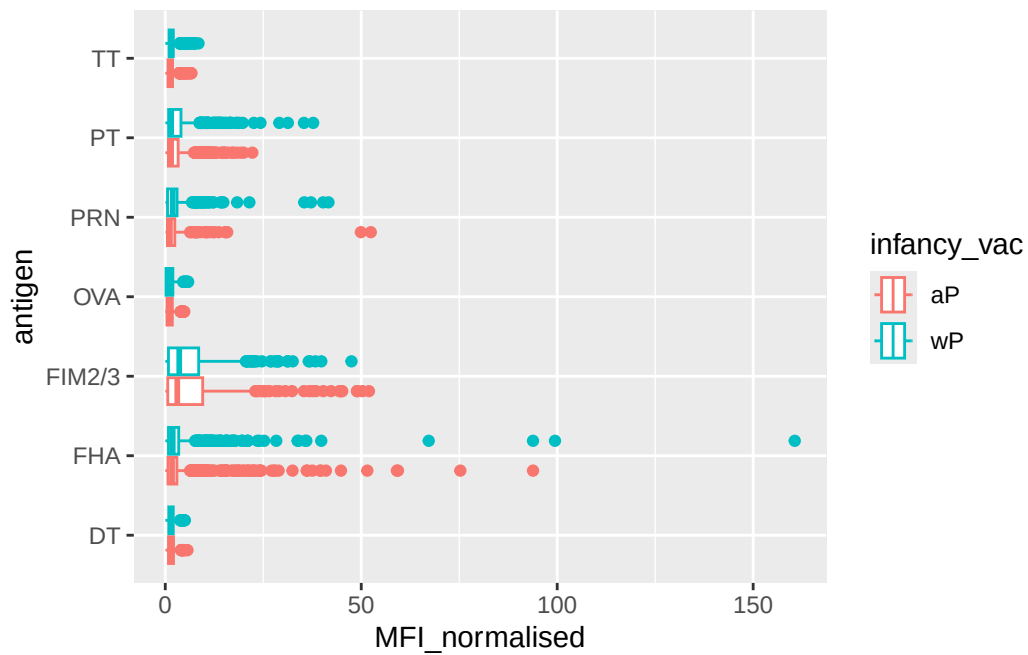
Differences between aP and wP

We can color up by the infancy_vac values of aP and wP

```

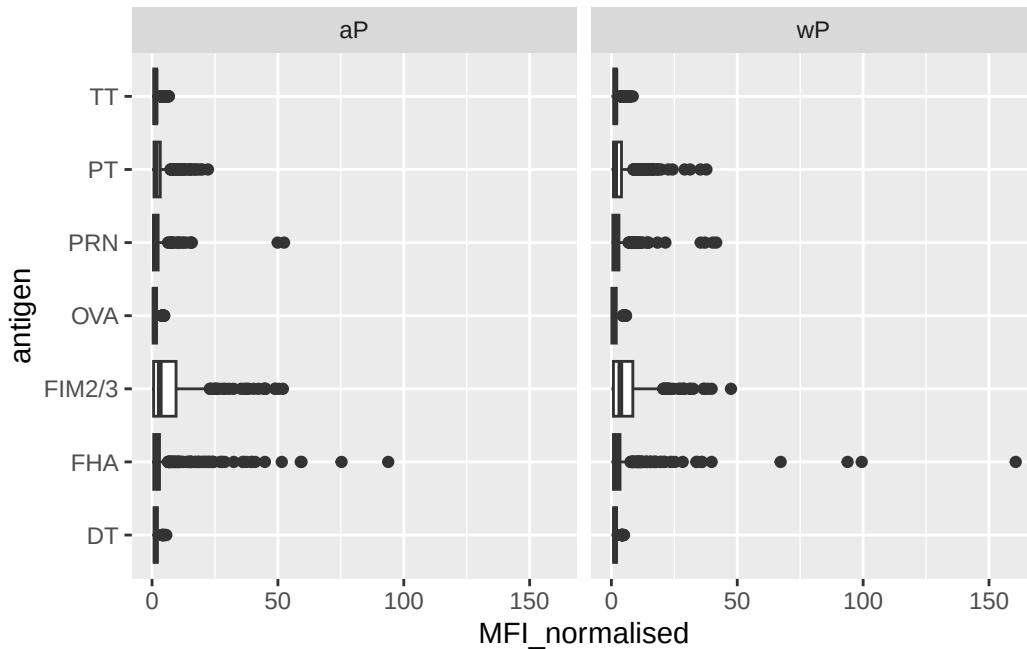
ggplot(igg) +
  aes(x=MFI_normalised, y =antigen, col=infancy_vac) +
  geom_boxplot()

```



We could also “facet” by the “aP” vs “wP” infancy_vac values

```
ggplot(igg) +
  aes(x=MFI_normalised, y =antigen) +
  geom_boxplot() +
  facet_wrap(~infancy_vac)
```



Q12. What are the different `$dataset` values in `abdata` and what do you notice about the number of rows for the most “recent” dataset?

Q13. Complete the following code to make a summary boxplot of Ab titer levels (MFI) for all antigens:

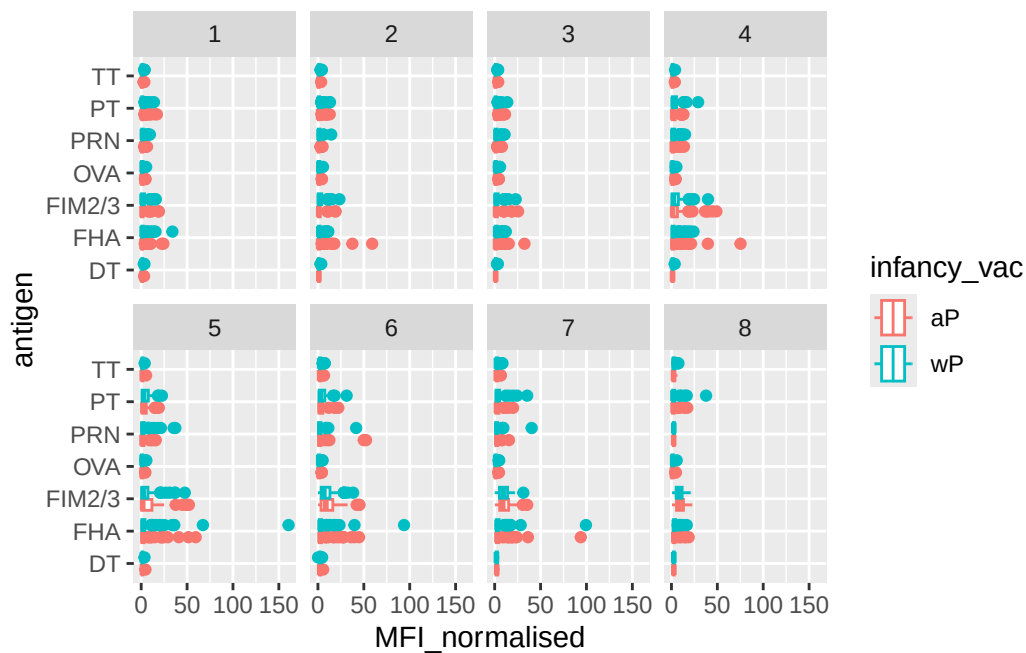
Time course analysis

We can use `visit` as a proxy for time here and facet our plots by this value 1 to 8...

```
table(ab_data$visit)
```

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
8280	8280	8420	8420	8420	8100	7700	2670	770	686	105	105

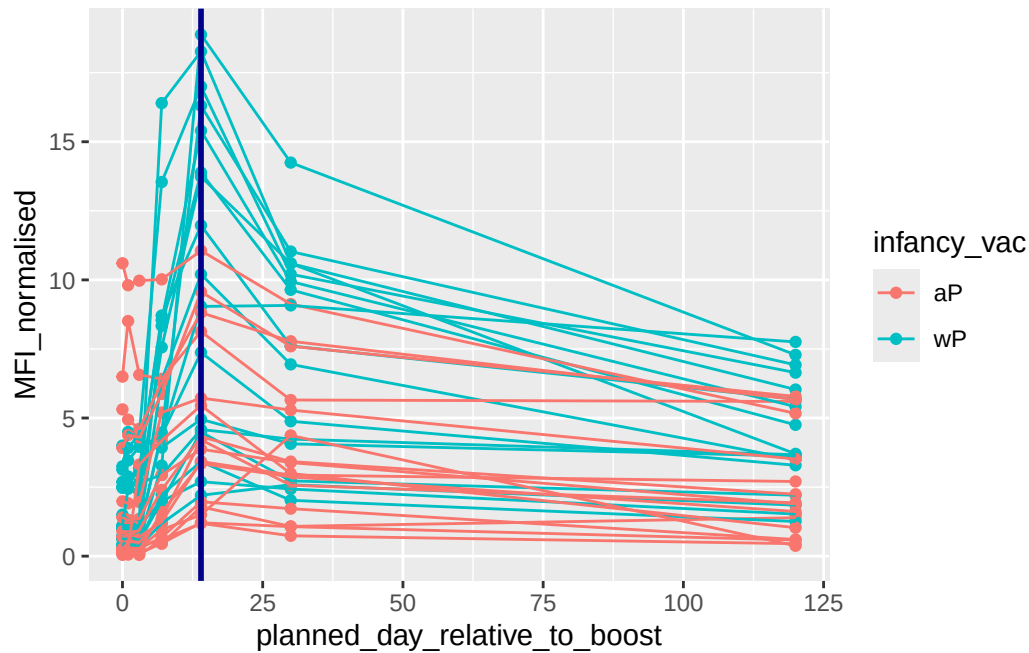
```
igg |>
  filter(visit %in% 1:8) |>
  ggplot() +
  aes(x=MFI_normalised, y =antigen, col=infancy_vac) +
  geom_boxplot() +
  facet_wrap(~visit, nrow=2)
```



Time course of PT (Virulence Factor: Pertussis toxin)

```
pt <- igg |>
  filter(antigen == "PT") |>
  filter(dataset=="2021_dataset")
```

```
ggplot(pt) +
  aes(x=planned_day_relative_to_boost,
      y=MFI_normalised,
      col=infancy_vac,
      group=subject_id) +
  geom_point() +
  geom_line() + # can't just do geom_line() without group because we have multiple subjects,
  geom_vline(xintercept=14, col="darkblue", linewidth=1) # they peak at same line but magnitud
```



System setup

```
sessionInfo()
```

```
R version 4.5.1 (2025-06-13)
Platform: aarch64-apple-darwin20
Running under: macOS Tahoe 26.1
```

```
Matrix products: default
```

```
BLAS:   /Library/Frameworks/R.framework/Versions/4.5-arm64/Resources/lib/libRblas.0.dylib
LAPACK: /Library/Frameworks/R.framework/Versions/4.5-arm64/Resources/lib/libRlapack.dylib;
```

```
locale:
```

```
[1] en_US.UTF-8/en_US.UTF-8/en_US.UTF-8/C/en_US.UTF-8/en_US.UTF-8
```

```
time zone: America/Los_Angeles
```

```
tzcode source: internal
```

```
attached base packages:
```

```
[1] stats      graphics  grDevices  utils      datasets  methods    base
```

other attached packages:

```
[1] jsonlite_2.0.0  lubridate_1.9.4 forcats_1.0.1  stringr_1.6.0
[5] dplyr_1.1.4    purrr_1.2.0    readr_2.1.6    tidyr_1.3.1
[9] tibble_3.3.0   tidyverse_2.0.0 ggplot2_4.0.1  datapasta_3.1.0
```

loaded via a namespace (and not attached):

```
[1] gtable_0.3.6      compiler_4.5.1    tidyselect_1.2.1  scales_1.4.0
[5] yaml_2.3.10       fastmap_1.2.0     R6_2.6.1          labeling_0.4.3
[9] generics_0.1.4    knitr_1.50        pillar_1.11.1     RColorBrewer_1.1-3
[13] tzdb_0.5.0        rlang_1.1.6       stringi_1.8.7     xfun_0.54
[17] S7_0.2.1          timechange_0.3.0  cli_3.6.5         withr_3.0.2
[21] magrittr_2.0.4    digest_0.6.39     grid_4.5.1        rstudioapi_0.17.1
[25] hms_1.1.4         lifecycle_1.0.4   vctrs_0.6.5       evaluate_1.0.5
[29] glue_1.8.0        farver_2.1.2      rmarkdown_2.30    tools_4.5.1
[33] pkgconfig_2.0.3   htmltools_0.5.8.1
```